

## Macbooks better now

The new Macbooks get a better CPU, faster GPU and a new battery that is good for ten hours – a win-win situation? But rumours of overheating rears its ugly head

## No pron?

Steve Jobs got into a flame war with Ryan Tate, a Gawker blogger via email. Among other topics, Jobs was against porn and promised "a world free from porn". Hmmm...

## VU LTV-46I

A solidly built display with a nice stand, the entire body features a glossy black finish. Initially we wondered about the extra thickness, then we noticed this display houses a small netbook-grade computer in its shell, which is why VU Technologies used the suffix "i", signifying intelligent. The display is quite heavy and the body made of solid plastics. For such a large screen it's a shame that the stand does not swivel. The remote needs to be pointed very accurately at the IR sensor, else will not work, this makes close operation problematic. There is an Intel Atom processor, 1 GB of RAM and a 160 GB hard drive built in, meaning you actually have a ready HTPC, albeit with the barest of hardware configurations. If this set up included the ION platform, we'd swallow it, since the Atom

processor struggles with HD content. It coughs and chokes on 720p content, let alone full 1080 videos. We'd also have liked a Blu-Ray optical drive – this would be a killer, but sadly wishes aren't horses.

While the blackness level is mediocre at best, it will do for the most part, although you will notice the deficiency. What is not good is the lack of variation in intensity in grey. In movies this is noticeable in darker scenes and even in certain well-lit scenes. One example was of a cobbled sidewalk that was grey in colour with a lot of variation as part of it was sunlit and part in the shade. It was interesting to note the blending of some grey here – the display evidently struggles to resolve detail present in grey.

When running *Crysis Warhead*, the display refused to display the



game at a resolution of 1080p and you see a blank blue screen (not to be mistaken with a BSOD). We needed to reset the game resolution lower than 1080p for this to work, surprisingly *S.T.A.L.K.E.R* worked fine at 1080p.

It's a feature rich display rich, but the MRP of Rs. 95,000 is hard to swallow. If it were a

great performing panel with an ION-based computer built into it, we'd have considered it, but the fact that you can buy an LG 47LH50YR and a PS3 for that price is reason enough to avoid recommending it. It is a novel solution however, and kudos to VU for coming out with something of the sort.

The display comes with some nifty built in games, accessible via the remote control unit; a plus, though given sufficient addiction, the longevity of the remote could suffer. This TV comes with a memory card slot and 3.5mm headphone out jack.

The display has a decent blackness level. Colours are pleasing, though we'd like a little bit of a natural look to some colours. In some scenes with a darker background with the foreground having lighter highlights detailing is visible. Skin tones are spot on – a strong plus. The pixel response seems to be on the lower side. In fast moving scenes, some sort of tearing appears. Gaming was a fun experience, except that we found the pixel response to be a problem when playing

fast action first person shooter games. The speakers are pretty basic, vocals have a slight distortion to them.

Priced at Rs. 31,990 the LB32R3 is a good buy, although it's also slightly pricier than the MoserBaer MBIK32HD that has a better quality panel. You couldn't go wrong between either of these displays – it shares the Best Buy with the excellent value-for-money MoserBaer MBIK32HD.



Samsung LA32C650L1RLXL

## Samsung LA-32C650L1RLXL

### 32" of Joy

The LA32C650 bespeaks quality from the time it's unpacked – thick plastic meets solid glass and metal here. The stand for starters, is pure glass, except the neck that, we suspect is transparent fibre. The rear is metal, unlike the other displays that use plastic. The remote is identical to the Samsung LED UA40C6900.

While calibrating we noticed mediocre blackness levels – but then, there were many displays that fared worse. The colour is generally good and tonally accurate – the colour levels aren't as splendid as it's LED sibling. There is good colour in movies, with a decent amount of detail in grey

– we were able to make out the detail and texturing of the mane of a black horse in one of the scenes where there was quite a bit of dark grey (clouds and shadows) and dark green (foliage). Only offerings from LG, Sony, and Samsung's own LED display could outdo this display.

One needs to keep the brightness really low to get a good black level, but the display does well with grey-scale intensity. It has an RJ45 port, Samsung@TV is supported.

The price was a little high, even for a high-end 32-inch, full-HD panel – Rs. 54,900 isn't as affordable as we'd have liked, but it's a fine full HD panel.

## Videocon 3205HD

### Get, set, go!

This display is well built, except for the stand that isn't stable.